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UAE Presidential Court

PRESIDENT, VICE-PRESIDENT ATTEND WORLD LAUREATES SUMMIT

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan and His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, attend the opening ceremony of the World Laureates Summit yesterday. The World Laureates Summit in Dubai brings together more than 100 Nobel laureates and recipients of leading international scientific honours.

SEE ALSO P-I

Khamenei warns of regional war as Trump confirms talks with Iran

Warning comes amid heavy US military deployments and fears of wider conflict

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Iran's supreme leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei yesterday warned that any US military strike would trigger a wider regional conflict, even as US President Donald Trump said Washington and Tehran were in talks aimed at averting escalation.

"The Americans should know that if they start a war, this time it will be a regional war," Khamenei was quoted as saying by Iran's Tasnim news agency, amid heavy US military deployments in the Gulf.

The warning came days after Trump confirmed dialogue was underway with Tehran, while

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian struck a conciliatory tone, warning that a wider conflict would hurt both sides.

simultaneously ordering major US naval assets — including an aircraft carrier strike group — closer to Iran's shores. "Iran is talking to us, and we'll see if we can do something," Trump said, adding that Washington was seeking a deal that would leave Iran without nuclear weapons.

In a separate address, Khamenei described the recent wave of anti-government protests across Iran — which have left thousands dead according to rights groups — as an attempted overthrow of the state.

"They attacked the police, government centres, IRGC centres, banks and mosques, and

burned the Quran... It was like a coup," he said, adding that the unrest had been "suppressed".

Progress made

Iran's top security official Ali Larijani said progress was being made toward negotiations with the United States, dismissing what he called a "contrived media war".

"Structural arrangements for negotiations are progressing," said Larijani, head of Iran's Supreme National Security Council, following talks in Moscow.

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian struck a conciliatory tone, warning that a wider conflict would hurt both sides.

But Iran's army chief Amir Hatami issued a blunt warning to Washington and Israel. "If the enemy makes a mistake, without a doubt it will endanger its own security, the security of the region, and the security of the Zionist regime," he said.

SEE ALSO P7

India's Budget 2026 rolls out targeted reforms for NRIs

Higher equity limits, simpler property deals and targeted tax relief explained

DUBAI

BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

India's Union Budget 2026-27 introduces several reforms aimed at making it easier for non-resident Indians (NRIs) to invest and comply with tax rules.

For equity investors, individuals classified as Persons Resident Outside India (PROIs) — which includes NRIs, OCIs and others based overseas under FEMA rules — can now invest up to 10 per cent in a listed Indian company under the Portfolio Investment Scheme, up from 5 per cent earlier. Property

transactions also get simpler. From October 1, 2026, resident buyers purchasing property from an NRI will no longer need a TAN to deduct tax at source, easing one-time compliance.

Small taxpayers with foreign assets get relief through the Foreign Assets Disclosure Scheme, 2026, covering legacy or accidental non-disclosures such as ESOPs, old bank accounts or insurance policies, with limited immunity.

Certain NRI businesses under presumptive taxation, including cruise operations and electronics manufacturing support, are exempt from Minimum Alternate Tax from FY27. From FY27, some NRI businesses won't have to pay minimum tax, and foreign companies supplying equipment to electronics factories in special zones will get tax relief till 2030-31.

SEE ALSO P-IV

UAE achieves historic \$1tr in non-oil trade

NON-OIL EXPORTS TOP DH813 BILLION, RECORDING 45 PER CENT GROWTH

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

For the first time in its history, the UAE's non-oil foreign trade has exceeded \$1 trillion, reaching Dh3.8 trillion, in yet another major milestone in the country's economic journey.

His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, announced the achievement in a post on his X account after reviewing the latest Foreign Trade Report.

Sheikh Mohammed stated that the record figure represents a 26 per cent increase compared to the previous year, demonstrating the accelerating momentum of the UAE's diversified economic model.

He further noted that non-oil exports exceeded Dh813 billion, recording an exceptional growth rate of 45 per cent year-on-year.

Five years ahead of time

Sheikh Mohammed highlighted that these figures were originally set as strategic targets to be achieved by 2031, yet 95 per cent of those targets have been realised five years ahead of schedule, thanks to the effectiveness of national economic policies and long-term planning.

Sheikh Mohammed emphasised that the UAE's investment environment has matured, its international partnerships have

DH355B DUBAI GDP

Dubai's economy maintained strong momentum in 2025, posting steady growth across key sectors and reinforcing the emirate's position as one of the region's most resilient business hubs. Gross domestic product (GDP) reached about Dh355 billion in the first nine months of the year, including Dh113.8 billion in the third quarter alone.

The economy expanded by 4.7 per cent during the nine-month period and by 5.3 per cent in the third quarter compared with the same timeframe in 2024, reflecting broad-based activity across industries.

expanded significantly, and collaboration with the private sector has grown stronger, reinforcing global confidence in the UAE as a trusted economic partner.

"The world's confidence in the UAE has been firmly established, by the grace of God," Sheikh Mohammed said.

He concluded by congratulating national teams across the country on this historic achievement, stressing that the next phase requires doubling efforts, deepening partnerships with the private sector, and continuing to build a more resilient and future-ready economic model.

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